

JHU - Krieger School of Arts & Sciences / Whiting School of Engineering

ASEN.2026.Spring Project 2

Course: EN.553.171.01.SP26: Discrete Mathematics
Instructor: Apurva Nakade *
Response Rate: 29/30 (96.67 %)

1 - The overall quality of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means							
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%		4.31	4.24	4.24					
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%									
Satisfactory				(3)	3	10.34%									
Good				(4)	14	48.28%									
Excellent				(5)	12	41.38%									
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%									
								0	25	50	100	Question	School Level	Department Level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median	
29/30 (96.67%)		4.31	0.66	4.00	11087		4.24	0.92	4.00	11087		4.24	0.92	4.00	

2 - The instructor's teaching effectiveness is:

Apurva Nakade

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means							
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%									
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%									
Satisfactory				(3)	2	6.90%									
Good				(4)	12	41.38%									
Excellent				(5)	15	51.72%									
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%									
								0	25	50	100	Question	School Level	Department Level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median	
29/30 (96.67%)		4.45	0.63	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00	

3 - The intellectual challenge of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	6	21.43%								
Good				(4)	11	39.29%								
Excellent				(5)	11	39.29%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
02550100								Question	School Level	Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
28/30 (93.33%)		4.18	0.77	4.00	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00

4 - The teaching assistant for this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	2	6.90%								
Satisfactory				(3)	8	27.59%								
Good				(4)	11	37.93%								
Excellent				(5)	7	24.14%								
N/A				(0)	1	3.45%								
							0	25	50	100	Question	School Level	Department Level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
29/30 (96.67%)		3.82	0.90	4.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00

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5 - Please enter the name of the TA you evaluated in question 4:

Response Rate	19/30 (63.33%)
• James • James • James • James • james • James • Adam • James • James Ritter • James • Adam • James • James • James Ritter • Many TA's • James • James • James • Nicolas Poliak	

6 - Feedback on my work for this course is useful:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Disagree strongly		(1)	0	0.00%		4.10		4.17		4.17				
Disagree somewhat		(2)	2	6.90%										
Neither agree nor disagree		(3)	4	13.79%										
Agree somewhat		(4)	12	41.38%										
Agree strongly		(5)	11	37.93%										
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%										
						0	25	50	100	Question	School Level		Department Level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
29/30 (96.67%)		4.10	0.90	4.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00

7 - Compared to other Hopkins courses at this level, the workload for this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means							
Much lighter				(1)	1	3.45%									
Somewhat lighter				(2)	1	3.45%									
Typical				(3)	14	48.28%									
Somewhat heavier				(4)	9	31.03%									
Much heavier				(5)	4	13.79%									
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%									
								0	25	50	100	Question	School Level	Department Level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median	
29/30 (96.67%)		3.48	0.91	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00	

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8 - What are the best aspects of this course?

Response Rate	18/30 (60%)
• Apurva is kind; you can tell he cares a lot about the success of his students. The homework is challenging and sometimes fun. • It is a very intense course but it gives you an amazing foundation for the remaining math classes. It also gives a really different and cool perspective on math. I also like having the TA section at the end of the week. • Writing the proofs which is nice when it all works out at the end • Light-ish workload, light curve, exam content is very similar to homeworks, homework redos • The topics, homework, and exams are very fair and intellectually engaging. • math. • Very structured class • Amount of practice problems given • This course reviews a lot of aspects of mathematics that I have learned before, which strengthens my ability of rigorous proof and discrete thinking. • Apurva is fantastic and this class was extremely interesting. • It is nice to review the techniques of proofs. • Teaching • Problems are good and the class is taught quite well. Tests are fair and you get a lot of resources. • The professor is a very good professor in my opinion and the course makes sense. • The textbook helps a lot • Topics • The professor cares about the students and invests heavily in them. He is always very focused on the student's learning evidenced by checking in with them during lecture to make sure they understand. The content is also very intellectually satisfying to learn. • Fun topics in math	

9 - What are the worst aspects of this course?

Response Rate	16/30 (53.33%)
• The lectures move slowly. At times, it is monotonous and dull. The Zybooks are tedious and annoying. • It's very intellectually challenging. If you aren't willing to give a bunch of time during the week you won't do good. • The difficult RSA encryption and the modulo arithmetic. • Multiple high-stakes exams • There's not a ton of consistency, and it feels like the topics are disconnected from one another. • required attendance and it is a bit too harsh for a freshman level course. I think it should be an 8 credit course to be fair. • Fast paced. • None. • I thought Friday sections were not helpful. • I am very frustrated with some evaluation rubrics. It could be fairer. • Grading feel arbitrary and some of the assignments are just not graded correctly/fairly. • I believe some of the homework questions were more difficult than expected. • A lot of hw that does not fully apply to test content • Hard • I don't fully understand the materials. • Office hours were not as frequent.	

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10 - What would most improve this class?

Response Rate 13/30 (43.33%)

- Moving at a faster pace and getting rid of the zybooks.
- I think just working through full proofs more thoroughly would be helpful. There were a bunch of practice sheets but not a lot of full practice problems aside from the HWs and the Midterms. I just wish there was a place with a bunch of problems that I could practice until I fully understood, that's how I learn best.
- Removing those topics
- Maybe tying the different topics together better
- cut some of the content and provide more reasonable back test for study.
- Not sure
- Lower required attendance because sometimes there are many conflicts between course and meetings.
- The grading.
- N/A
- Less homework or homework more similar to the exams
- I know the curve after tests
- Perhaps pushing the midterm dates earlier so at the end of the semester there is more time between finishing the third midterm and the final.
- Going a bit slower or splitting it into two semester class.

11 - What should prospective students know about this course before enrolling? (You may comment on any aspect of this course such as assumed background, readings, grading systems, and so on.)

Response Rate 15/30 (50%)

- It's a chill class. Probably the easiest math class I've taken here so far.
- It's a very difficult course and requires a ton of out of class work. I would recommend doing the HWs early in the week so that Professor Apurva can check them before you submit and give yourself a second chance at attempting the problem.
- It is a great course and definitely would recommend taking. It is a good balance of intellectually challenging and intriguing
- Overall it's a fair class but if you don't study and keep up with the work you will struggle
- It is very very hard. It is definitely harder than 99% of the 100 level course and the workload is more than a typical 4 credits course. Anyways, i don't think Hopkins admin cares , but this is my opinion
- try to find areas of mathematics you want to continue exploring through this course
- Really recommended for beginning math lovers.
- This course is not as hard as some make it out to be. I got a lot out of it.
- It is not a fun class, but it is something you will need to learn.
- It's going to be a decent amount of work but the content is taught in a way that is good for understanding.
- I believe this course is fair.
- go to class and pay attention and practice simple things a lot
- It's hard
- Study a lot more than u think u need.
- Not everything in the reading is covered in the lecture.